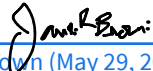


James R. Brown
Jeanne & John R. Blocker Chair in Business Administration
Professor and Department Head

MEMORANDUM

TO: Philipp Illeditsch, Assistant Professor, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance

FROM: Jamie Brown, Head, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance 
Jamie Brown (May 29, 2025 11:18 CDT)

SUBJECT: Annual Performance Review: January 1, 2024 – December 31, 2024

Both Texas A&M University and Mays Business School require that the performance of all faculty be reviewed on an annual basis. As noted in the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines, the purposes of the annual performance review include:

- Creating a sound and logical basis for merit compensation recommendations
- Providing evaluative feedback regarding how well the individual is currently performing
- Providing developmental feedback regarding areas where the faculty member's contribution may be enhanced and/or improved in the future
- Providing feedback regarding progress toward promotion and/or tenure as relevant

Further, the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines define four levels of performance for the key dimensions across which performance is reviewed. These levels of performance are:

- *Excellent performance*: a high level of performance that meets and exceeds norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *excellence*;
- *Effective performance*: performance that meets norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *effective* performance;
- *Needs improvement performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *effective* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *needs improvement* performance;
- *Unsatisfactory performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *excellent*, *effective*, and *needs improvement* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *unsatisfactory* performance.

This letter serves as your performance review for the 2024 calendar year. The following reflects information provided in your Faculty 180 submission. In addition, the tenured Finance faculty had the opportunity to review your annual report (containing detailed information about your research, teaching, and service) and current resume and provided me with their assessment and feedback. In the sections below, I first briefly summarize the main contributions you have made in each area, present the assessment of the tenured faculty, and provide my own independent assessment.

Research

Highlights of your research activity during the three-year evaluation window include:

- In the last three years, you had no publications or acceptances of research papers.
- You produced new working papers and received another revise-and-resubmit request from the Journal of Financial Economics, a top three journal in Finance.
- You submitted multiple working papers to top journals in Finance and Economics.
- You were active in Finance conferences as both discussant and presenter.

Teaching

- You taught one section of FINC 351 (Investment Analysis), one section of FINC 688 (first-year PhD seminar), and one section of FINC 689 (Stochastic Methods in Finance).
- The design and materials for your courses are at the appropriate level of rigor, and the student evaluations are strong.

Service

- You served as primary grader for the first-year qualifying exam for the PhD students.
- You provided service to the profession through refereeing papers for top journals and discussing papers at conferences.
- You served as a member of two dissertation committees.

Tenured Faculty Assessment

As you will see below, the tenured faculty unanimously rated your research performance as “needs improvement.” The reason for the rating is that you must go up for promotion and tenure this coming year, and you have no new acceptances of papers at top journals in your probationary period. We strongly encourage you to resubmit your paper to the JFE as soon as possible to try to secure an acceptance. Although time is very short, to the extent possible, we also strongly encourage you to advance other papers to the R&R or acceptance stage.

Your teaching performance continues to be excellent (unanimous), and we greatly appreciate your contributions in that area. Similarly, we also greatly appreciate your contributions in the service area, in particular your contributions to the Ph.D. program.

Ratings (votes) from Tenured Faculty

Research: Needs improvement (9)

Teaching: Excellent (9)

Service: Effective (9)

As a colleague: Excellent (9)

Overall: Needs improvement (9)

Additional Comments from Tenured Faculty

- Time is very short for him. To whatever extent possible, he needs to significantly improve his research record before he applies for promotion and tenure.

Department Head Assessment

I agree with the assessment of the tenured faculty. Your teaching and service contributions are excellent. Notably, you serve as a referee for numerous top journals and conferences and are in exceedingly high demand as discussant, all of which speaks to your reputation and high standing in the field.

Your research trajectory is a concern given how close we are to your mandatory tenure review. You have several promising research projects at various stages of completion, and it is important for you to move these forward as fast as possible given your mandatory tenure review in Fall 2025. Toward this end, I applaud your goal of strengthening your tenure case by publishing the JFE paper and submitting multiple other working papers to top journals by the end of the summer. It will be challenging to get one of the working papers all the way through the acceptance process before your tenure review, but even an R&R will show research promise and strengthen your case. If there is something the department can do to help you achieve these goals, I hope you will let me know!

I am particularly grateful for your service contributions to the department, particularly your engagement with the PhD program.

Thank you very much for your contributions to the Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance and Mays Business School. It is a pleasure to work with you!

Please acknowledge receipt of this evaluation by signing below. Note that your signature does not indicate your agreement with the contents of this evaluation.

Philipp Illeditsch
Philipp Illeditsch (Jun 2, 2025 10:50 CDT)
Philipp Illeditsch

06/02/2025
Date

Illeditsch 2024 Annual Review

Final Audit Report

2025-06-02

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